



RAA CHESS WEEK

July 20 – 27, 2026 · RAA.SPACE, Matīsa iela 8, Rīga

Presented to **BALCIA**

About the Event

RAA Chess Week is a seven-day festival of chess, culture and community at RAA.SPACE in Rīga's creative Veldze quarter. Bringing together a simultaneous exhibition, a chess opera with international performers, chess theatre, a children's workshop, a poetry evening, daily chess café sessions and a closing Hand & Brain team tournament, the festival makes chess a living art form — accessible to players, artists, families and the curious of all ages. RAA Chess Week will be a singular moment on Latvia's cultural calendar.

Programme

Mon 20	Welcome Evening (<i>World Chess Day</i>) 17:00 Opening 18:00 Bruno Rancis — Introduction & Free Chess Class 20:00 Simultaneous Exhibition — Mikelis Vingris
Tue 21	Chess Café (14:00–16:00 & 19:00–22:00) Chessboard Making — <i>Rūdolfs Bekičs</i> Children's Workshop: stage design (organized by <i>Lieto Fine</i>)
Wed 22	Chess Café (14:00–16:00) International Opera Night (17:00–18:30) <i>F.-A. Philidor: Baroque Opera "Blaise et Blaisine"</i> <i>Lieto Fine + Latvian baroque musicians</i>
Thu 23	Chess Café (14:00–16:00 & 19:00–22:00) Chess Theatre <i>Leonhard Horstmeyer & Santa Didžus & students of the New Theatre Institute of Latvia</i> Meisterklasse on Openings
Fri 24	Chess Café (14:00–16:00 & 19:00–22:00) Poetry, Literature & Chess Evening <i>Poetry Group Sintakses stupors</i>
Sat 25	Hand & Brain Tournament
Sun 26	<i>Partner chess: the Brain calls the piece, the Hand plays the move</i>

Audience & Reach

- **300+** total visitors across the festival
- **80 seats** at the Opera Night
- For all ages — players, artists, students, enthusiasts
- Instagram **@raa_riga** & **@veldze.radosarupnica**: combined **7,000+** followers
- Rīga media outlets:
100gkultura & **riga-neighbourhood**
& **arterritory.com** & **notboring.riga**

Why It Matters

Chess is experiencing a global cultural renaissance. RAA Chess Week places **BALCIA** at the intersection of **intellect, art and community** — an audience that is engaged, curious and multi-generational. Sponsorship here is a genuine investment in Latvia's cultural life, seen and felt across Rīga's creative community.

Sponsorship Package — € 2 500

Mentioned everywhere	BALCIA is acknowledged at every event, on all print materials, and on the RAA.SPACE event page.
Social media	Dedicated posts + stories across @raa_riga, @veldze.radosarupnica, riga-neighbourhood, notboring.riga, 100gkultura and arterritory.com (7,000+ combined reach).
Opera Night	3 reserved VIP seats at the Opera Night (Wed 22 Jul).
Speaking opportunity	3-minute welcome address at the Opening Evening (Mon 20 Jul).
On-site presence	BALCIA display in the RAA foyer for all seven days of the festival.
Press release	Named as principal sponsor in all media communications.